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ASIA WEEK AHEAD CHINA INDIA

Asia week ahead: Indian rate decision and data on Philippines, Indonesia, China

India's rate decision is the highlight of the week, though the Reserve Bank of India is expected to keep rates unchanged. Key data releases include Philippine GDP and inflation, Indonesia's second-quarter GDP, China's trade figures, and Taiwan's inflation and trade



Asia Research highlights of the week

[Bank Indonesia's leadership change – continuity or shifting priorities?](#)

[Inflation dynamics strengthen the case for an extended RBA hold](#)

[China's Politburo strikes a supportive tone but offers few tangible measures](#)

[The winners and losers of China's K-shaped economy](#)

India: RBI expected to keep rates unchanged

We expect the Reserve Bank of India to keep the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% on Wednesday. While headline inflation surprised to the upside in June, largely due to higher fuel prices, underlying price pressures remain contained. Core inflation continues to run below the RBI's target, providing policymakers with sufficient room to keep policy rates unchanged while monitoring evolving risks to the inflation outlook. Particularly from elevated oil prices and the potential impact of a severe El Niño event on food prices.

Philippines: GDP and inflation in focus

Philippines GDP growth is expected to remain subdued in the second quarter at a 3.5% year-on-year pace, as elevated oil prices and continued political uncertainty keep investment activity muted. On the positive side, government spending should begin to recover after contracting in the second half of 2025, providing some support to domestic demand. Export growth is also expected to strengthen relative to the first quarter, with the Philippines benefiting from deeper integration into the AI supply chain. However, higher oil and non-oil import prices are likely to weigh on the trade balance, resulting in a smaller net contribution from external demand to overall GDP growth.

We expect CPI inflation in July to remain unchanged at 6.4% YoY. Food inflation should ease somewhat, with lower rice prices providing relief after the sharp increase recorded in June. However, fuel inflation is likely to continue edging higher, driven by increases in retail fuel prices. Services inflation is expected to remain sticky, reflecting persistent underlying price pressures in the sector.

Indonesia: Slower 2Q GDP growth expected

We expect Indonesian GDP growth to slow sharply to 5.0% YoY in 2Q from 5.6% previously, reflecting a challenging environment for private investment amid weak business confidence. Growth is also likely to be weighed down by a deterioration in the trade balance, as exports soften while oil imports remain relatively firm, driven by higher oil prices.

China: Trade data to highlight export strength

China releases its trade data on Friday. We look for exports and imports to remain strong, with 28.1% YoY growth for exports and 33.6% YoY growth for imports, for a trade surplus of \$112.6bn. Trade is expected to continue to be dominated by tech-related categories. Markets might continue to watch for signs of China's oil imports recovering or further stagnating.

Taiwan: Inflation and trade data in focus

Taiwan releases its inflation data on Wednesday. We look for inflation to moderate slightly to

2.4% YoY, which remains above target. Upside surprises might add to pressure for a rate hike in September, while an undershoot might reduce this pressure. Taipei will also release trade data on Thursday. We are looking for both exports and imports to edge up in July, to 43.6% YoY and 56.4% YoY, respectively, for a trade surplus of \$15.2bn. Trade growth is expected to remain strong in the third quarter.

Key events in Asia next week

THINK economic and financial analysis

Country	Time (GMT+8)	Data/event	ING	Prev.
Monday 3 August				
Japan	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI Final	-	54,7
China	0945	Jul RatingDog Manufacturing PMI	-	51,7
India	1300	Jul HSBC Manufacturing PMI Final	-	53,9
Malaysia	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	50,7
Indonesia	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	46,9
	1200	Jul Core CPI (YoY%)	-	2,8
	1200	Jul Inflation (YoY%)	3,2	3,3
	1200	Jun Trade Balance (USD bn)	-	-1,6
	1200	Jun Exports Growth (YoY%)	-	-5,7
	1200	Jun Imports Growth (YoY%)	-	22,2
Philippines	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	50,9
Singapore	2100	Jul Manufacturing PMI	-	51,3
Taiwan	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	55,2
Thailand	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	53,6
South Korea	0830	Jul S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	52,1
Tuesday 4 August				
Japan	0750	Jul Monetary Base (YoY%)	-	-13,7
Hong Kong	1630	Jun Retail Sales (YoY%)	-	4,8
South Korea	0700	Jul CPI (MoM%/YoY%)	CF:0/3,0	0.1/3,2
Wednesday 5 August				
Japan	0830	Jul S&P Global Services PMI Final	-	51,9
	0830	Jul S&P Global Composite PMI Final	-	53,1
New Zealand	0645	Q2 Unemployment Rate (%)	-	5,3
China	0945	Jul RatingDog Services PMI	-	54,1
	0945	Jul RatingDog Composite PMI	-	53,6
India	1230	Rate Decision (%)	5,25	5,25
	1230	Cash Reserve Ratio (%)	-	3
	1300	Jul S&P Global Services PMI	-	53,1
	1300	Jul S&P Global Composite PMI	-	54,3
Hong Kong	0830	Jul S&P Global PMI	-	52
Indonesia	1200	Q2 GDP (YoY%)	5	5,6
	1200	Q2 GDP (QoQ%)	-	-0,8
Philippines	0900	Jul CPI (YoY%)	6,4	6,4
	0900	Jul CPI (MoM%/YoY%)	-/-	-0.3/4,4
Singapore	1300	Jun Retail Sales (MoM%/YoY%)	-/-	-2.3/3
Taiwan	1620	Jul Foreign Exchange Reserves (USD bn)	-	597,2
Thailand	1130	Jul CPI (YoY%)	-	2,4
	1130	Jul CPI Core Inflation (YoY%)	-	1,2
Thursday 6 August				
Philippines	0900	Jun Unemployment Rate (%)	-	4,8
	0900	Jun Industrial Production (YoY%)	-	13,5
Taiwan	1600	Jul CPI (YoY%)	2,4	2,6
South Korea	0700	Jun Current Account Balance (USD bn)	-	38,6
Friday 7 August				
Japan	0730	Jun All Household Spending (MoM%/YoY%)	-/-	3.7/-0.4
China	0700	Jul Exports (YoY%)	28,1	27
	0700	Jul Imports (YoY%)	33,6	36
	0700	Jul Trade Balance (USD bn)	112,6	125,6
		- Jul FX Reserves (USD tn)	-	3,4
India	1930	Jul FX Reserves (USD bn)	-	676,2
Indonesia	1100	Jul FX Reserves (USD bn)	-	145,6
Philippines	1000	Q2 GDP(YoY%)	3,5	2,8
		- Jul FX Reserves (USD bn)	-	104,8
Singapore	1700	Jul FX Reserves (SGD bn)	-	551,3
Taiwan	1600	Jul Imports (YoY%)	56,4	51,8
	1600	Jul Exports (YoY%)	43,6	40,3
	1600	Jul Trade Balance (USD bn)	15,2	12,2
Thailand	1530	Jul FX Reserves (USD bn)	-	279
		- Jul Consumer Confidence	-	50,7

Note : CF = Market consensus forecast data

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